# The Noble Dharma Discourse Called "The Eight Maṇḍalas," a Great Vehicle Sūtra

Āryamaṇḍalāṣṭanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 105 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དཀྱིལ་འཁོར་བརྒྱད་ཅས་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་འཆོས་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་གྲུས་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

The Noble Dharma Discourse Called "The Eight Maṇḍalas," a Great Vehicle Sūtra, is known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Maṇḍala Aṣṭa Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as Phakpa Kyilkhor Gyé Chejawé Chökyi Namdrang Thekpa Chenpoi Do. It is a Mahāyāna sūtra set at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada's park, where the Buddha is teaching before a vast assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, gods, and other beings. The discourse begins when the bodhisattva Siṃharājavyūha, struck with wonder at the great maṇḍala of the gathered assembly, rises respectfully to address the Blessed One, and the teaching that follows unfolds around the theme of eight maṇḍalas named in its title. The work is Toh 105 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general collection of Great Vehicle sūtras.

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In the language of India: ārya maṇḍala aṣṭa nāma mahāyāna sūtra
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dharma Discourse Called "The Eight Maṇḍalas," a Great Vehicle Sūtra.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of monks and a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas. Surrounded by many gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, and facing them, he was teaching the Dharma.

At that time a bodhisattva called Siṃharājavyūha had joined that assembly and was seated there. When he saw the great maṇḍala of the assembly, he was filled with wonder. He rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and set his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said to him:

"Blessed One, I have passed through the appearance of many trillions of buddhas, yet the maṇḍala of no one's assembly was ever like that of the Blessed One. Blessed One, please give an answer to this question I put to you. If other bodhisattvas hear it, they too will take heart."

Then, in order to uplift the entire assembly, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Siṃharājavyūha:

"Listen, son of noble family, and I shall answer what you have asked. I shall teach the Dharma discourse called The Eight Maṇḍalas, which I formerly, while still an ordinary person, practiced, cultivated, and did many times.

"Son of noble family, in times past there lived a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly awakened buddha called Inconceivable Light. He lived, he endured, and he taught the Dharma. At that time there was a householder called Rudradatta who was utterly without faith, possessed five unpleasant qualities, and had turned his back on the Dharma and the Vinaya. A monk called Source of Victory, out of compassion for that householder, went again and again, without interruption, to the householder's house.

"At length, through the force of time, the householder came to feel attachment toward that monk, and one day the householder asked him about the fruits of virtuous deeds. Then, for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit and happiness of the great multitude of gods and humans, the monk taught the householder the Dharma discourse called The Eight Maṇḍalas:

"'Householder, what is the Dharma discourse called The Eight Maṇḍalas? It is what grants every happiness. Through it one will obtain an excellent retinue: wherever one is born, one will never be separated from sentient beings who possess the Dharma. With a large retinue and an excellent body, one will obtain beauty of form. One will obtain excellent provisions: the provisions one would otherwise have to seek will come to one. One will obtain a body that is hard and firm, an excellent body, which even mountains and walls cannot obstruct. These are the four excellences one will obtain.'

"Then that householder was delighted, pleased and overjoyed. He bowed at the monk's feet and said: 'Noble one, teach me the eight maṇḍalas, so that they become directly evident to me.'

"Then the monk Source of Victory, knowing the householder's intention, taught it fully and correctly: 'Son of noble family, listen, and I shall teach it.

Therefore, with fresh cow dung mixed in,
Make a square maṇḍala, smooth and even.
In common with all sentient beings,
To whatever buddhas there are of the past,

To those to come and those now present,
And to whatever bodhisattvas, śrāvakas
And pratyekabuddhas there may be,
To all of them dedicate it fully.
Then all around the maṇḍala
Make the maṇḍalas of the retinue:
Lokeśvara and Maitreya,
The sage, supreme of beings, Ākāśagarbha,
Samantabhadra the wise,
The Lord of Secrets (Vajrapāṇi),
Mañjuśrī, the Youthful One,
Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin,
And likewise Kṣitigarbha:
For their sake make the eight maṇḍalas.

"'Householder, this is the Dharma discourse called The Eight Maṇḍalas. I heard it directly from that Blessed One, the Tathāgata Inconceivable Light. Householder, listen further:

Whoever wishes for retinues
Of fully matching fortune
Should draw the eight maṇḍalas.
Whoever wishes for the state of Śakra (Indra),
For lordship of the world of Brahmā,
For the kingship of gods and human kings,
The wise who wish for varied, lovely forms,
Should always make the eight supreme maṇḍalas.'

"Siṃharājavyūha, what do you think of this? If you suppose that the monk called Source of Victory at that time was someone else, do not view it so. This Mañjuśrī, the Youthful One, was at that time, on that occasion, the monk called Source of Victory. Siṃharājavyūha, if you have doubt or hesitation, thinking that the householder called Rudradatta at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not view it so. I myself was at that time, on that occasion, the householder called Rudradatta. Until I had perfected the six perfections and until I attained buddhahood, throughout those hundreds of thousands of trillions of lifetimes I practiced this Dharma, cultivated it, and did it many times. Son of noble family, that is the cause and that is the condition by which the maṇḍala of my assembly has come to be arrayed like this."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Siṃharājavyūha, those monks, those bodhisattvas, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra, the Dharma discourse called The Eight Maṇḍalas.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra, the chief editor and translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, and others.

Here is contained volume Ca of the Sūtra section.

## Translator's Notes

• Siṃharājavyūha is a reconstruction of the bodhisattva's name (literally "Array of the Lion King"). The names of the tathāgata, Inconceivable Light, and of the monk, Source of Victory, are translated from the Tibetan because their Sanskrit forms cannot be fixed with confidence. Rudradatta renders "given by the Fierce One," where the Fierce One is a standard Tibetan rendering of Rudra. The phrase about provisions literally reads "provisions that need to be sought will come"; it is rendered in the sense of not having to seek them. In the verse list of the eight bodhisattvas, "sage, supreme of beings" is taken as epithets of Ākāśagarbha, and "the wise" as an epithet of Samantabhadra.
• The final line is a scribal marker of the Kangyur volume in which the text appears. It is not part of the sūtra itself.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.